

Temperament Field Notes

Field notes, not a report card. Neither end of any trait is the good end.

Child's first name or nickname _____

Age _____

How to use this page

1 = little or low, 3 = right in the middle, 5 = a lot or high.

Pick the number closest to how they usually are, not their best or worst day.

Babies and toddlers: picture them on an ordinary day. Older kids: picture a slightly new or uncomfortable setting.

Arriving somewhere a little new

1. Approach / Withdrawal

When something or someone is new, how do they respond?

1 = holds back and watches first

5 = moves toward it right away

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

2. Activity level

How much do they move?

1 = calm and still

5 = always on the move

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

3. Sensitivity

How much do they notice noise, light, textures, or changes in the room?

1 = barely registers

5 = notices everything

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

4. Mood

What is their general lens?

1 = serious and watchful

5 = cheerful and open

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Across an ordinary week

5. Regularity

How predictable are their hunger, sleep, and routines?

1 = varies day to day

5 = like clockwork

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Working on something hard

6. Persistence

When it's frustrating, do they keep going?

1 = moves on quickly

5 = sticks with it

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

7. Distractibility

How easily are they pulled away by what's happening around them?

1 = stays locked in

5 = easily pulled away

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

8. Adaptability

When plans change, how quickly do they adjust?

1 = needs time to reset

5 = adjusts quickly

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

9. Intensity of reaction

How big are their reactions, upset or delighted?

1 = even and quiet

5 = big and expressive

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Notes to myself

Your Own Field Notes

Your plot matters too. Same nine traits, same scale, and still no good end.

How to use this page

Chart yourself the way you charted your child. Picture yourself arriving somewhere a little new, then working on something hard. 1 = little or low, 3 = right in the middle, 5 = a lot or high.

Pick the number closest to how you usually are, not how you wish you were or how you are on your worst day.

Arriving somewhere a little new

1. Approach / Withdrawal

When something or someone is new, how do you respond?

1 = holds back and watches first

5 = moves toward it right away

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

2. Activity level

How much do you move?

1 = calm and still

5 = always on the move

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

3. Sensitivity

How much do you notice noise, light, textures, or changes in the room?

1 = barely registers

5 = notices everything

☐☐☐☐☐

1

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3

4

5

4. Mood

What is your general lens?

1 = serious and watchful

5 = cheerful and open

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Across an ordinary week

5. Regularity

How predictable are your hunger, sleep, and routines?

1 = varies day to day

5 = like clockwork

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Working on something hard

6. Persistence

When it's frustrating, do you keep going?

1 = moves on quickly

5 = sticks with it

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1

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3

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7. Distractibility

How easily are you pulled away by what's happening around you?

1 = stays locked in

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1

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8. Adaptability

When plans change, how quickly do you adjust?

1 = needs time to reset

5 = adjusts quickly

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1

2

3

4

5

9. Intensity of reaction

How big are your reactions, upset or delighted?

1 = even and quiet

5 = big and expressive

☐☐☐☐☐

1

2

3

4

5

Notes to myself

Your Plots, Side by Side

Where your child's garden and yours overlap, and where the soil asks for something different.

● Your child ● You

In Adobe Acrobat, your answers from pages 1 and 2 appear here on their own. In other viewers, click your dots here.

Arriving somewhere a little new	1	2	3	4	5
1. Approach / Withdrawal 1 = holds back and watches first 5 = moves toward it right away	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
2. Activity level 1 = calm and still 5 = always on the move	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
3. Sensitivity 1 = barely registers 5 = notices everything	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
4. Mood 1 = serious and watchful 5 = cheerful and open	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
Across an ordinary week	1	2	3	4	5
5. Regularity 1 = varies day to day 5 = like clockwork	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
Working on something hard	1	2	3	4	5
6. Persistence 1 = moves on quickly 5 = sticks with it	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
7. Distractibility 1 = stays locked in 5 = easily pulled away	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
8. Adaptability 1 = needs time to reset 5 = adjusts quickly	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐
9. Intensity of reaction 1 = even and quiet 5 = big and expressive	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐	child ☐ you ☐

How to read this page

Where the two dots sit close together, your plots overlap, and what grows easily in you may grow easily in them. Where they sit far apart, the soil may ask for something different from what comes naturally to you. Close numbers can still clash (two intense people can ignite each other), and far-apart numbers can balance each other. This page shows where to get curious. It is not a verdict on anyone.

What I notice